

include Lithium-Ion (Li-Ion) rechargeable ones and Nickel Metal Hydride (Ni-MH) batteries. Li-Ion batteries can store charges for long durations at a time and though they may seem to be a more expensive option to invest in, they last much longer than most other types. Ni-MH batteries are the most common replacement for standard AA, since they can be recharged each time. Another popular option available is CR-V3 batteries, an equivalent to 2AAs, which come in both rechargeable and non-rechargeable versions. A small tip to help you with rechargeable batteries is to look for the milli-Ampere-hours (mAh) number. This is an indicator of how long the battery will last when fully charged, with a larger number implying more run time when the camera is in use.

Investing in a decent battery grip will also prove fruitful if you intend to click photo after photo on a regular basis. Multiple Li-Ion or AA batteries can be stored in these optional compartments attached usually to the bottom of the camera body. Not only do they give prolonged power to the camera, battery grips also generally have a shutter release button and often include a similar set of additional control devices as are present on the camera body, which make operating the camera much easier for taking portrait photographs while holding the camera vertically. Battery grips may be slightly on the expensive side and could even add to the weight of a digital SLR, but they could prove to be very useful for photographers who click a lot of portraits by avoiding wrist strains.

Special features

Image stabilisation

Some version of this technology, even though called by different names, exists in all dSLRs today. Be it Canon's Image Stabilization (IS) or Nikon's Vibration Reduction (VR), both are essentially the same thing, allowing for much sharper images in dim light or with long lenses. While for still subjects like in studios or setups both IS and VR work perfectly fine, when shooting moving subjects like sports or kids, VR doesn't have much use as it only helps reduce camera motion and can't stop subject motion. They basically provide you with an option to get rid of the blurring effects from hand holding and even help replace the tripod for making sharp photos. They can also be employed to achieve better motion panning shots, wherein VR blurs one side while stabilising the other.

Don't confuse or equate these technologies with the term "anti-shake" popularised by makers who wrongfully use it even when they're merely